'To the devil with your Grimaud! He will spoil the feast.'

'I will direct him to stand behind your chair, and since he doesn't speak, your highness will neither see nor hear him and with a little effort can imagine him a hundred miles away.'

'Do you know, my friend, I find one thing very evident in all this, you distrust me.'

'My lord, the day after to-morrow is Pentecost.'

'Well, what is Pentecost to me? Are you afraid that the Holy Spirit will come as a tongue of fire to open the doors of my prison?'

'No, my lord; but I have already told you what that damned magician predicted.'

'And what was it?'

'That the day of Pentecost would not pass without your highness being out of Vincennes.'

'You believe in sorcerers, then, you fool?'

'I—-I mind them no more than that— ' and he snapped his fingers; 'but it is my Lord Giulio who cares about them; as an Italian he is superstitious.'

The duke shrugged his shoulders.

'Well, then,' with well acted good-humour, 'I allow Grimaud, but no one else; you must manage it all. Order whatever you like for supper—the only thing I specify is one of those pies; and tell the confectioner that I will promise him my custom if he excels this time in his pies—not only now, but when I leave my prison.'

'Then you think you will some day leave it?' said La Ramée.

'The devil!' replied the prince; 'surely, at the death of Mazarin. I am fifteen years younger than he is. At Vincennes, 'tis true, one lives faster— '

'My lord,' replied La Ramée, 'my lord— '

'Or dies sooner, for it comes to the same thing.'

La Ramée was going out. He stopped, however, at the door for an instant.

'Whom does your highness wish me to send to you?'

'Any one, except Grimaud.'

'The officer of the guard, then, with his chessboard?'

'Yes.'

Five minutes afterward the officer entered and the duke seemed to be immersed in the sublime combinations of chess.

A strange thing is the mind, and it is wonderful what revolutions may be wrought in it by a sign, a word, a hope. The duke had been five years in prison, and now to him, looking back upon them, those five years, which had passed so slowly, seemed not so long a time as were the two days, the forty-eight hours, which still parted him from the time fixed for his escape. Besides, there was one thing that engaged his most anxious thought—in what way was the escape to be effected? They had told him to hope for it, but had not told him what was to be hidden in the mysterious pâté. And what friends awaited him without? He had friends, then, after five years in prison? If that were so he was indeed a highly favoured prince. He forgot that besides his friends of his own sex, a woman, strange to say, had remembered him. It is true that she had not, perhaps, been scrupulously faithful to him, but she had remembered him; that was something.

So the duke had more than enough to think about; accordingly he fared at chess as he had fared at tennis; he made blunder upon blunder and the officer with whom he played found him easy game.

But his successive defeats did service to the duke in one way—they killed time for him till eight o'clock in the evening; then would come night, and with night, sleep. So, at least, the duke believed; but sleep is a capricious fairy, and it is precisely when one invokes her presence that she is most likely to keep him waiting. The duke waited until midnight, turning on his mattress like St Laurence on his gridiron. Finally he slept.

But at daybreak he awoke. Wild dreams had disturbed his repose. He dreamed that he was endowed with wings—he wished to fly away. For a time these wings supported him, but when he reached a certain height this new aid failed him. His wings were broken and he seemed to sink into a bottomless abyss, whence he awoke, bathed in perspiration and nearly as much overcome as if he had really fallen. He fell asleep again and another vision appeared. He was in a subterranean passage by which he was to leave Vincennes. Grimaud was walking before him with a lantern. By degrees the passage narrowed, yet the duke continued his course. At last it became so narrow that the fugitive tried in vain to proceed. The sides of the walls seem to close in, even to press against him. He made fruitless efforts to go on; it was impossible. Nevertheless, he still saw Grimaud with his lantern in front, advancing. He wished to call out to him but could not utter a word. Then at the other extremity he heard the footsteps

of those who were pursuing him. These steps came on, came fast. He was discovered; all hope of flight was gone. Still the walls seemed to be closing on him; they appeared to be in concert with his enemies. At last he heard the voice of La Ramée. La Ramée took his hand and laughed aloud. He was captured again, and conducted to the low and vaulted chamber, in which Ornano, Puylaurens, and his uncle had died. Their three graves were there, rising above the ground, and a fourth was also there, yawning for its ghastly tenant.

The duke was obliged to make as many efforts to awake as he had done to go to sleep; and La Ramée found him so pale and fatigued that he inquired whether he was ill.

'In fact,' said one of the guards who had remained in the chamber and had been kept awake by a toothache, brought on by the dampness of the atmosphere, 'my lord has had a very restless night and two or three times, while dreaming, he called for help.'

'What is the matter with your highness?' asked La Ramée.

''Tis your fault, you simpleton,' answered the duke. 'With your idle nonsense yesterday about escaping, you worried me so that I dreamed that I was trying to escape and broke my neck in doing so.'

La Ramée laughed.

'Come,' he said, ''tis a warning from Heaven. Never commit such an imprudence as to try to escape, except in your dreams.'

'And you are right, my dear La Ramée,' said the duke, wiping away the sweat that stood on his brow, wide awake though he was; 'after this I will think of nothing but eating and drinking.'

'Hush!' said La Ramée; and one by one he sent away the guards, on various pretexts.

'Well?' asked the duke when they were alone.

'Well!' replied La Ramée, 'your supper is ordered.'

'Ah! and what is it to be? Monsieur, my majordomo, will there be a pie?'

'I should think so, indeed—almost as high as a tower.'

'You told him it was for me?'

'Yes, and he said he would do his best to please your highness.'

'Good!' exclaimed the duke, rubbing his hands.

'You are right,' said the duke. 'If I am to remain here permanently, as Monsieur Mazarin has kindly given me to understand, I must provide myself with a diversion for my old age, I must turn gourmand.'

'My lord,' said La Ramée, 'if you will take a bit of good advice, don't put that off till you are old.'

'Good!' said the Duc de Beaufort to himself, 'every man in order that he may lose his heart and soul, must receive from celestial bounty one of the seven capital sins, perhaps two; it seems that Master La Ramée's is gluttony. Let us then take advantage of it.' Then, aloud:

'Well, my dear La Ramée! the day after to-morrow is a holiday.'

'Yes, my lord—Pentecost.'

'Will you give me a lesson the day after to-morrow?'

'In what?'

'In gastronomy?'

'Willingly, my lord.'

'But *tête-à-tête*. Send the guards to take their meal in the canteen of Monsieur de Chavigny; we'll have a supper here under your direction.'

'Hum!' said La Ramée.

The proposal was seductive, but La Ramée was an old stager, acquainted with all the traps a prisoner was likely to set. Monsieur de Beaufort had said that he had forty ways of getting out of prison. Did this proposed breakfast cover some stratagem? He reflected, but he remembered that he himself would have charge of the food and the wine and therefore that no powder could be mixed with the food, no drug with the wine. As to getting him drunk, the duke couldn't hope to do that, and he laughed at the mere thought of it. Then an idea came to him which harmonised everything.

The duke had followed with anxiety La Ramée's unspoken soliloquy, reading it from point to point upon his face. But presently the exempt's face suddenly brightened.

'Well,' he asked, 'that will do, will it not?'

'Yes, my lord, on one condition.'

'What?'

'That Grimaud shall wait on us at table.'

Nothing could be more agreeable to the duke, however, he had presence of mind enough to exclaim:

The duke went indoors and retired to bed, where he spent, indeed, the greater part of every day, as they had taken his books away. La Ramée carried off all his clothes, in order to be certain that the duke would not stir. However, the duke contrived to hide the ball under his bolster and as soon as the door was closed he tore off the cover of the ball with his teeth and found underneath the following letter:

> My Lord,
>
> Your friends are watching over you and the hour of your deliverance is at hand. Ask day after to-morrow to have a pie supplied you by the new confectioner opposite the castle, and who is no other than Noirmont, your former *maître d'hôtel*. Do not open the pie till you are alone. I hope you will be satisfied with its contents.
>
> Your highness's most devoted servant,
> In the Bastille, as elsewhere,
> Comte de Rochefort.

The duke, who had latterly been allowed a fire, burned the letter, but kept the ball, and went to bed, hiding the ball under his bolster. La Ramée entered; he smiled kindly on the prisoner, for he was an excellent man and had taken a great liking for the captive prince. He endeavoured to cheer him up in his solitude.

'Ah, my friend!' cried the duke, 'you are so good; if I could but do as you do, and eat pâtés and drink Burgundy at the house of Father Marteau's successor.'

''Tis true, my lord,' answered La Ramée, 'that his pâtés are famous and his wine magnificent.'

'In any case,' said the duke, 'his cellar and kitchen might easily excel those of Monsieur de Chavigny.'

'Well, my lord,' said La Ramée, falling into the trap, 'what is there to prevent your trying them? Besides, I have promised him your patronage.'

'Devil take it, my lord! what a gourmand you are growing; I haven't seen you with so cheerful a face these five years.'

The duke saw that he had not controlled himself as he ought, but at that moment, as if he had listened at the door and comprehended the urgent need of diverting La Ramée's ideas, Grimaud entered and made a sign to La Ramée that he had something to say to him.

La Ramée drew near to Grimaud, who spoke to him in a low voice.

The duke meanwhile recovered his self-control.

'I have already forbidden that man,' he said, 'to come in here without my permission.'

'You must pardon him, my lord,' said La Ramée, 'for I directed him to come.'

'And why did you so direct when you know that he displeases me?'

'My lord will remember that it was agreed between us that he should wait upon us at that famous supper. My lord has forgotten the supper.'

'No, but I have forgotten Monsieur Grimaud.'

'My lord understands that there can be no supper unless he is allowed to be present.'

'Go on, then; have it your own way.'

'Come here, my lad,' said La Ramée, 'and hear what I have to say.'

Grimaud approached, with a very sullen expression on his face.

La Ramée continued: 'My lord has done me the honour to invite me to a supper to-morrow *en tête-à-tête*.'

Grimaud made a sign which meant that he didn't see what that had to do with him.

'Yes, yes,' said La Ramée, 'the matter concerns you, for you will have the honour to serve us; and besides, however good an appetite we may have and however great our thirst, there will be something left on the plates and in the bottles, and that something will be yours.'

Grimaud bowed in thanks.

'And now,' said La Ramée, 'I must ask your highness's pardon, but it seems that Monsieur de Chavigny is to be away for a few days and he has sent me word that he has certain directions to give me before his departure.'

The duke tried to exchange a glance with Grimaud, but there was no glance in Grimaud's eyes.

'Go, then,' said the duke, 'and return as soon as possible.'

'Does your highness wish to take revenge for the game of tennis yesterday?'

Grimaud intimated by a scarcely perceptible nod that he should consent.

'Yes,' said the duke, 'but take care, my dear La Ramée, for I propose to beat you badly.'

La Ramée went out. Grimaud looked after him, and when the door was closed he drew out of his pocket a pencil and a sheet of paper.

'Write, my lord,' he said.

'And what?'

Grimaud dictated.

'All is ready for to-morrow evening. Keep watch from seven to nine. Have two riding horses ready. We shall descend by the first window in the gallery.'

'What next?'

'Sign your name, my lord.'

The duke signed.

'Now, my lord, give me, if you have not lost it, the ball—that which contained the letter.'

The duke took it from under his pillow and gave it to Grimaud. Grimaud gave a grim smile.

'Well?' asked the duke.

'Well, my lord, I sew up the paper in the ball and you, in your game of tennis, will send the ball into the ditch.'

'But will it not be lost?'

'Oh no; there will be some one at hand to pick it up.'

'A gardener?'

Grimaud nodded.

'The same as yesterday?'

Another nod on the part of Grimaud.

'The Count de Rochefort?'

Grimaud nodded the third time.

'Come, now,' said the duke, 'give some particulars of the plan for our escape.'

'That is forbidden me,' said Grimaud, 'until the last moment.'

Chapter XIX

Pâtés Made by the Successor of Father Marteau Are Described

In half an hour La Ramée returned, full of glee, like most men who have eaten, and more especially drank to their heart's content. The pâtés were excellent, the wine delicious.

The weather was fine and the game at tennis took place in the open air.

At two o'clock the tennis balls began, according to Grimaud's directions, to take the direction of the moat, much to the joy of La Ramée, who marked fifteen whenever the duke sent a ball into the moat; and very soon balls were wanting, so many had gone over. La Ramée then proposed to send some one to pick them up, but the duke remarked that it would be losing time; and going near the rampart himself and looking over, he saw a man working in one of the numerous little gardens cleared out by the peasants on the opposite side of the moat.

'Hey, friend!' cried the duke.

The man raised his head and the duke was about to utter a cry of surprise. The peasant, the gardener, was Rochefort, whom he believed to be in the Bastille.

'Well? Who's up there?' said the man.

'Be so good as to collect and throw us back our balls,' said the duke.

The gardener nodded and began to fling up the balls, which were picked up by La Ramée and the guard. One, however, fell at the duke's feet, and seeing that it was intended for him, he put it into his pocket.

La Ramée was in ecstasies at having beaten a prince of the blood.

'Who will be waiting for me beyond the ditch?'

'I know nothing about it, my lord.'

'But at least, if you don't want to see me turn crazy, tell what that famous pâté will contain.'

'Two poniards, a knotted rope and a *poire d'angoisse*.[1]'

'Yes, I understand.'

'My lord observes that there will be enough to go around.'

'We shall take to ourselves the poniards and the rope,' replied the duke.

'And make La Ramée eat the pear,' answered Grimaud.

'My dear Grimaud, thou speakest seldom, but when thou dost, one must do thee justice—thy words are words of gold.'

[1]This *poire d'angoisse* was a famous gag, in the form of a pear, which, being thrust into the mouth, by the aid of a spring, dilated, so as to distend the jaws to their greatest width.

'Go, then, animal,' said the duke; 'but remember, I only allow you half an hour.'

'May I promise your custom to the successor of Father Marteau, my lord?'

'Yes, if he does not put mushrooms in his pies; thou knowest that mushrooms from the wood of Vincennes are fatal to my family.'

La Ramée went out, but in five minutes one of the officers of the guard entered in compliance with the strict orders of the cardinal that the prisoner should never be left alone a moment.

But during these five minutes the duke had had time to read again the note from Madame de Montbazon, which proved to the prisoner that his friends were concerting plans for his deliverance, but in what way he knew not.

But his confidence in Grimaud, whose petty persecutions he now perceived were only a blind, increased, and he conceived the highest opinion of his intellect and resolved to trust entirely to his guidance.

'That if the astrologer in question made almanacs I would advise him not to buy one.'

'Why not?'

'Because before you could escape you would have to be turned into a bird.'

'Unfortunately, that is true. Let us go and have a game at tennis, La Ramée.'

'My lord—I beg your highness's pardon—but I must beg for half an hour's leave of absence.'

'Why?'

'Because Monseigneur Mazarin is a prouder man than his highness, though not of such high birth: he forgot to ask me to breakfast.'

'Well, shall I send for some breakfast here?'

'No, my lord; I must tell you that the confectioner who lived opposite the castle—Daddy Marteau, as they called him— '

'Well?'

'Well, he sold his business a week ago to a confectioner from Paris, an invalid, ordered country air for his health.'

'Well, what have I to do with that?'

'Why, good Lord! this man, your highness, when he saw me stop before his shop, where he has a display of things which would make your mouth water, my lord, asked me to get him the custom of the prisoners in the donjon. "I bought," said he, "the business of my predecessor on the strength of his assurance that he supplied the castle; whereas, on my honour, Monsieur de Chavigny, though I've been here a week, has not ordered so much as a tartlet." "But," I then replied, "probably Monsieur de Chavigny is afraid your pastry is not good." "My pastry not good! Well, Monsieur La Ramée, you shall judge of it yourself and at once." "I cannot," I replied; "it is absolutely necessary for me to return to the château." "Very well," said he, "go and attend to your affairs, since you seem to be in a hurry, but come back in half an hour." "In half an hour?" "Yes, have you breakfasted?" "Faith, no." "Well, here is a pâté that will be ready for you, with a bottle of old Burgundy." So, you see, my lord, since I am hungry, I would, with your highness's leave— ' And La Ramée bent low.

Chapter XX

One of Marie Michon's Adventures

WHILST these projects were being formed by the Duc de Beaufort and Grimaud, the Comte de la Fère and the Vicomte de Bragelonne were entering Paris by the Rue du Faubourg Saint Marcel.

They stopped at the sign of the Fox, in the Rue du Vieux Colombier, a tavern known for many years by Athos, and asked for two bedrooms.

'You must dress yourself, Raoul,' said Athos, 'I am going to present you to some one.'

'To-day, monsieur?' asked the young man.

'In half an hour.'

The young man bowed. Perhaps, not being endowed with the endurance of Athos, who seemed to be made of iron, he would have preferred a bath in the river Seine of which he had heard so much, and afterward his bed; but the Comte de la Fère had spoken and he had no thought but to obey.

'By the way,' said Athos, 'take some pains with your toilet, Raoul; I want you to be approved.'

'I hope, sir,' replied the youth, smiling, 'that there's no idea of a marriage for me; you know of my engagement to Louise?'

Athos, in his turn, smiled also.

'No, don't be alarmed, although it is to a lady that I am going to present you, and I am anxious that you should love her— '

The young man looked at the count with a certain uneasiness, but at a smile from Athos he was quickly reassured.

'How old is she?' inquired the Vicomte de Bragelonne.

'My dear Raoul, learn, once for all, that that is a question which is never asked. When you can find out a woman's age by her face, it is useless to ask it; when you cannot do so, it is indiscreet.'

'Is she beautiful?'

'Sixteen years ago she was deemed not only the prettiest, but the most graceful woman in France.'

This reply reassured the vicomte. A woman who had been a reigning beauty a year before he was born could not be the subject of any scheme for him. He retired to his toilet. When he reappeared, Athos received him with the same paternal smile as that which he had often bestowed on D'Artagnan, but a more profound tenderness for Raoul was now visibly impressed upon his face.

Athos cast a glance at his feet, hands and hair—those three marks of race. The youth's dark hair was neatly parted and hung in curls, forming a sort of dark frame around his face; such was the fashion of the day. Gloves of gray kid, matching the hat, well displayed the form of a slender and elegant hand; whilst his boots, similar in colour to the hat and gloves, confined feet small as those of a boy twelve years old.

'Come,' murmured Athos, 'if she is not proud of him, she must be hard to please.'

It was three o'clock in the afternoon. The two travellers proceeded to the Rue Saint Dominique and stopped at the door of a magnificent hotel, surmounted with the arms of De Luynes.

''Tis here,' said Athos.

He entered the hotel and ascended the front steps, and addressing a footman who waited there in a grand livery, asked if the Duchess de Chevreuse was visible and if she could receive the Comte de la Fère?

The servant returned with a message to say, that, though the duchess had not the honour of knowing Monsieur de la Fère, she would receive him.

Athos followed the footman, who led him through a long succession of apartments and paused at length before a closed door. Athos made a sign to the Vicomte de Bragelonne to remain where he was.

'I protest, my dear La Ramée,' said the duke, 'that you are a charming fellow and that I would stay forever at Vincennes to have the pleasure of your society.'

'My lord,' replied La Ramée, 'I think if it depended on the cardinal your wishes would be fulfilled.'

'What do you mean? Have you seen him lately?'

'He sent for me to-day.'

'Really! to speak to you about me?'

'Of what else do you imagine he would speak to me? Really, my lord, you are his nightmare.'

The duke smiled with bitterness.

'Ah, La Ramée! if you would but accept my offers! I would make your fortune.'

'How? you would no sooner have left prison than your goods would be confiscated.'

'I shall no sooner be out of prison than I shall be master of Paris.'

'Pshaw! pshaw! I cannot hear such things said as that; this is a fine conversation with an officer of the king! I see, my lord, I shall be obliged to fetch a second Grimaud!'

'Very well, let us say no more about it. So you and the cardinal have been talking about me? La Ramée, some day when he sends for you, you must let me put on your clothes; I will go in your stead; I will strangle him, and upon my honour, if that is made a condition I will return to prison.'

'Monseigneur, I see well that I must call Grimaud.'

'Well, I am wrong. And what did the *cuistre* [pettifogger] say about me?'

'I admit the word, monseigneur, because it rhymes with *ministre* [minister]. What did he say to me? He told me to watch you.'

'And why so? why watch me?' asked the duke uneasily.

'Because an astrologer had predicted that you would escape.'

'Ah! an astrologer predicted that?' said the duke, starting in spite of himself.

'Oh, *mon Dieu!* yes! those imbeciles of magicians can only imagine things to torment honest people.'

'And what did you reply to his most illustrious eminence?'

'I wish my lord would make me one promise.'

'What! speak!'

''Tis this: when we escape together, that I shall go everywhere and be always first; for if my lord should be overtaken and caught, there's every chance of his being brought back to prison, whereas if I am caught the least that can befall me is to be—hung.'

'True, on my honour as a gentleman it shall be as thou dost suggest.'

'Now,' resumed Grimaud, 'I've only one thing more to ask—that your highness will continue to detest me.'

'I'll try,' said the duke.

At this moment La Ramée, after the interview we have described with the cardinal, entered the room. The duke had thrown himself, as he was wont to do in moments of dullness and vexation, on his bed. La Ramée cast an inquiring look around him and observing the same signs of antipathy between the prisoner and his guardian he smiled in token of his inward satisfaction. Then turning to Grimaud:

'Very good, my friend, very good. You have been spoken of in a promising quarter and you will soon, I hope, have news that will be agreeable to you.'

Grimaud saluted in his politest manner and withdrew, as was his custom on the entrance of his superior.

'Well, my lord,' said La Ramée, with his rude laugh, 'you still set yourself against this poor fellow?'

'So! 'tis you, La Ramée; in faith, 'tis time you came back again. I threw myself on the bed and turned my nose to the wall, that I mightn't break my promise and strangle Grimaud.'

'I doubt, however,' said La Ramée, in sprightly allusion to the silence of his subordinate, 'if he has said anything disagreeable to your highness.'

'*Pardieu!* you are right—a mute from the East! I swear it was time for you to come back, La Ramée, and I was eager to see you again.'

'Monseigneur is too good,' said La Ramée, flattered by the compliment.

'Yes,' continued the duke, 'really, I feel bored today beyond the power of description.'

'Then let us have a match in the tennis court,' exclaimed La Ramée.

'If you wish it.'

'I am at your service, my lord.'

The footman opened the door and announced Monsieur le Comte de la Fère.

Madame de Chevreuse, whose name appears so often in our story *The Three Musketeers,* without her actually having appeared in any scene, was still a beautiful woman. Although about forty-four or forty-five years old, she might have passed for thirty-five. She still had her rich fair hair; her large, animated, intelligent eyes, so often opened by intrigue, so often closed by the blindness of love. She had still her nymph-like form, so that when her back was turned she still was not unlike the girl who had jumped, with Anne of Austria, over the moat of the Tuileries in 1563. In all other respects she was the same mad creature who threw over her amours such an air of originality as to make them proverbial for eccentricity in her family.

She was in a little boudoir, hung with blue damask, adorned by red flowers, with a foliage of gold, looking upon a garden; and reclined upon a sofa, her head supported on the rich tapestry which covered it. She held a book in her hand and her arm was supported by a cushion.

At the footman's announcement she raised herself a little and peeped out, with some curiosity.

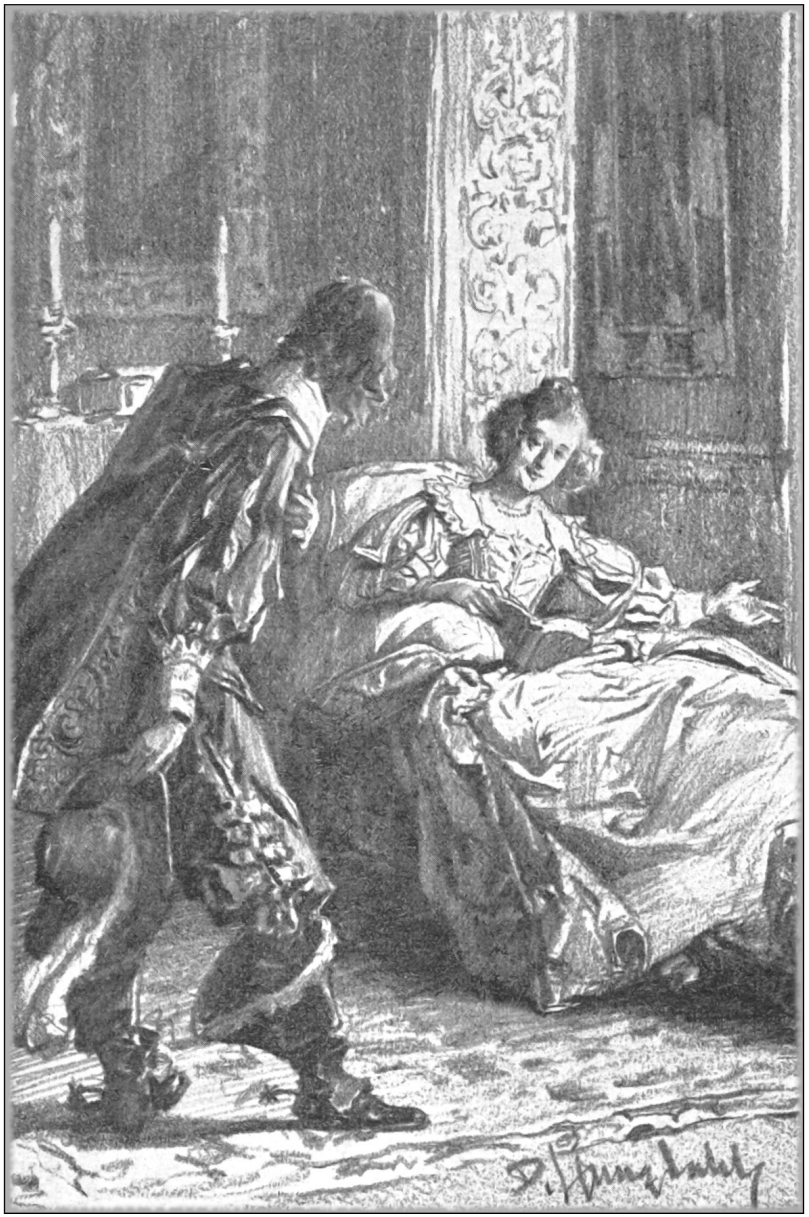
Athos appeared.

He was dressed in violet-tinted velvet, trimmed with silk of the same colour. His shoulder-knots were of burnished silver, his mantle had no gold nor embroidery on it; a simple plume of violet feathers adorned his hat; his boots were of black leather, and at his girdle hung that sword with a magnificent hilt that Porthos had so often admired in the Rue Féron. Splendid lace adorned the falling collar of his shirt, and lace fell also over the top of his boots.

In his whole person he bore such an impress of high degree, that Madame de Chevreuse half rose from her seat when she saw him and made him a sign to sit down near her.

Athos bowed and obeyed. The footman was withdrawing, but Athos stopped him by a sign.

'Madame,' he said to the duchess, 'I have had the boldness to present myself at your hotel without being known to you; it has succeeded, since you deign to receive me. I have now the boldness to ask you for an interview of half an hour.'



Madame de Chevreuse made him a sign to sit down near her

The poor duke became perfectly giddy. What for five years he had been wanting—a faithful servant, a friend, a helping hand—seemed to have fallen from Heaven just when he expected it the least.

'Oh, dearest Marie! she thinks of me, then, after five years of separation! Heavens! there is constancy!' Then turning to Grimaud, he said:

'And thou, my brave fellow, thou consentest thus to aid me?'

Grimaud signified his assent.

'And you have come here with that purpose?'

Grimaud repeated the sign.

'And I was ready to strangle you!' cried the duke.

Grimaud smiled.

'Wait, then,' said the duke, fumbling in his pocket. 'Wait,' he continued, renewing his fruitless search; 'it shall not be said that such devotion to a grandson of Henry IV went without recompense.'

The duke's endeavours evinced the best intention in the world, but one of the precautions taken at Vincennes was that of allowing prisoners to keep no money. Whereupon Grimaud, observing the duke's disappointment, drew from his pocket a purse filled with gold and handed it to him.

'Here is what you are looking for,' he said.

The duke opened the purse and wanted to empty it into Grimaud's hands, but Grimaud shook his head.

'Thank you, monseigneur,' he said, drawing back; 'I am paid.'

The duke went from one surprise to another. He held out his hand. Grimaud drew near and kissed it respectfully. The grand manner of Athos had left its mark on Grimaud.

'What shall we do? and when? and how proceed?'

'It is now eleven,' answered Grimaud. 'Let my lord at two o'clock ask leave to make up a game at tennis with La Ramée and let him send two or three balls over the ramparts.'

'And then?'

'Your highness will approach the walls and call out to a man who works in the moat to send them back again.'

'I understand,' said the duke.

Grimaud made a sign that he was going away.

'Ah!' cried the duke, 'will you not accept any money from me?'